dollar), with the support of central banks for settlement of these currencies.[3] In these respects, the business agenda broadly coincides with the government's one, as we see in the final declaration of Fortaleza and the agreement on the creation of the New Development Bank (NDB) and the Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA), which contemplate these recommendations.

At this point there is convergence between the governments of BRICS, businessmen and trade unions. Trade union federations from the five countries, which met in Fortaleza the same day as the business meeting, declared their full support for the NDB as an instrument for the transformation of the global economic architecture. From the point of view of these unions, the BRICS represent a key step towards democratisation of international relations and multipolarity.[4]

The business meeting also engaged in a formal networking session, where 600 companies from agribusiness, mining, infrastructure, pharmaceuticals, information technology, energy, green economy and finance did deals estimated to be worth US$3.9 billion.[5] Finally, another area of business activity, created in Durban in 2013, is the BRICS Business Council, with direct and formalised dialogue with the governments of these countries.

A very different situation arises for unions, social movements and NGOs from the BRICS countries. In their declarations, unions expressed their claim to recognition of the BRICS Trade Union Forum as an institutional space within the formal structure of the group, as it is recognised for the Business Council. They also expressed their intention to participate in working groups and in the NDB in order to open space for social participation in the BRICS.[6]

Other movements, networks and NGOs joined the 'Dialogues on development: the BRICS from the perspective of the people', from 14 to 16 July, which I was able to attend. It was organised in conjunction with local movements in Fortaleza, one of the host cities of the World Cup, which saw a series of protests and social struggles in 2014.[7] The environment in Fortaleza had been radicalised prior to the World Cup, and we can imagine that if the BRICS Summit occurred in March, as planned earlier, we would have had very large protests. However, as it took place immediately after the World Cup, the atmosphere was one of relative exhaustion. The BRICS are not a topic of concern to Brazilian social movements, which have their own agendas, and thus would not attract a large mobilisation. International issues are always distant from local movements' agendas. The last breakthrough was the continental struggle against the Free Trade Area of the Americas ten years earlier, in bringing international issues to everyday life. The mobilisations around the meeting of the Inter-American